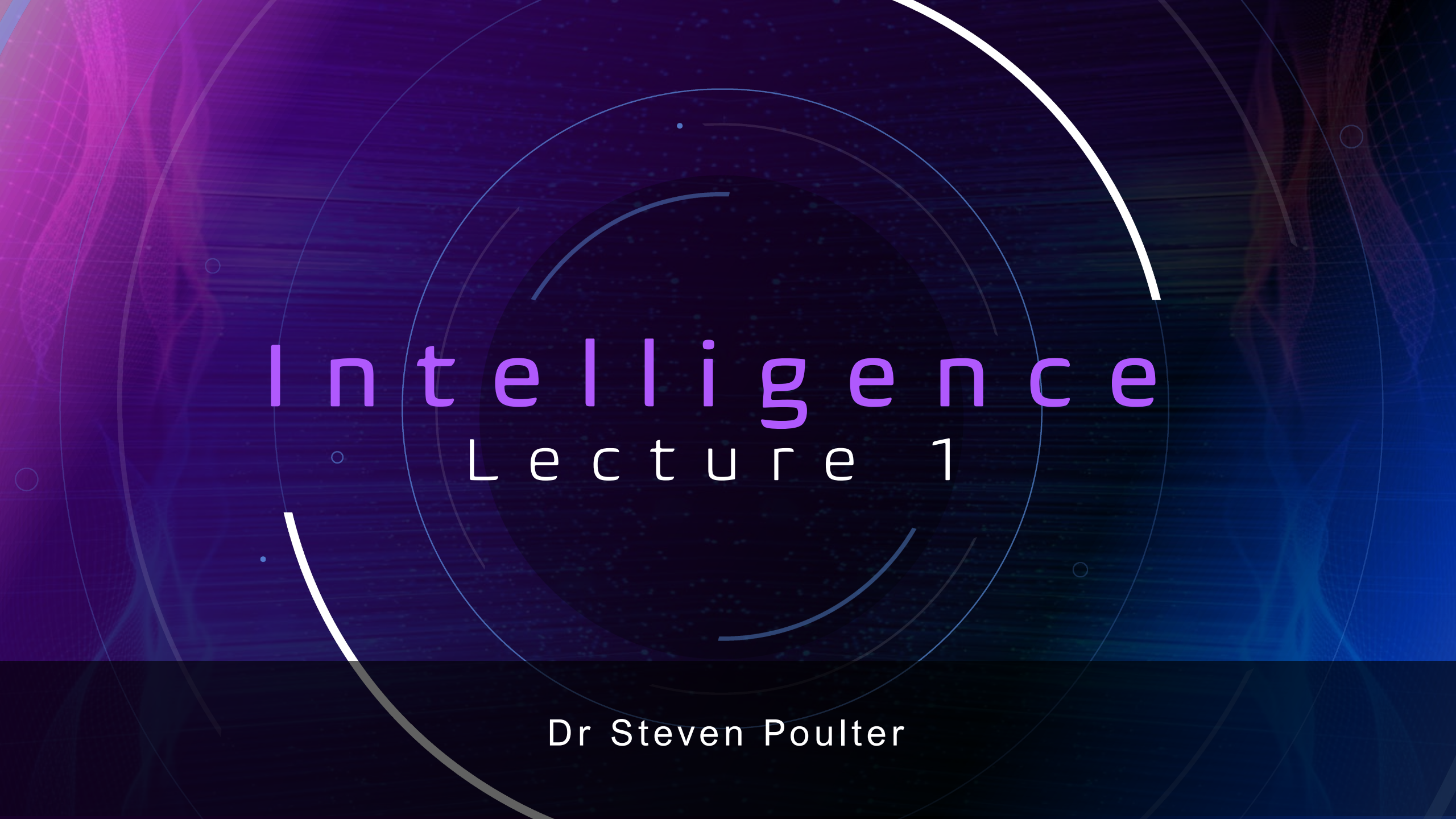


The background features a dark blue-to-purple gradient. Overlaid on this are several concentric circles of varying sizes and colors (white, light blue, and purple). A faint grid pattern is visible in the upper left and right corners. The text 'Intelligence' is in a light purple, monospace-style font, and 'Lecture 1' is in a white, monospace-style font, both centered horizontally.

Intelligence

Lecture 1

Dr Steven Poulter

Intro. to Psychology 2: Developmental and Social Psychology

November 11th, 2025, 10-11am
Teaching and Learning Centre
Room TLC042



Learning Outcomes

- Acquisition of knowledge in the topic of intelligence
- Detailed understanding of some sub-areas within the topic of intelligence
- Understanding of the relationship between data & theory
- Develop ability to organise and utilise knowledge



Lecture Key Themes

- Definition of intelligence
- Implicit theories of intelligence
- Expert and non-expert (lay-persons) theories of intelligence
- Implicit theories of intelligence across the life-span
- Implicit theories of intelligence across cultures

Glossary of Key Terms

Intelligence

A general mental capability involving reasoning, planning, problem-solving, abstract thinking, understanding complex ideas, learning quickly, and learning from experience. Often linked to the ability to adapt effectively to one's environment.

General mental ability

The broad, overarching capacity that underlies performance across many different cognitive tasks (sometimes referred to as “g” in intelligence research).

Capacity to learn from experience

The aspect of intelligence that reflects how well a person can learn, update, and use knowledge based on past events.

Capacity to adapt to the environment

The ability to change behaviour, strategies or thinking in response to demands or challenges in one's surroundings.

Hypothetical construct

An explanatory concept used in psychology that cannot be observed directly (e.g., intelligence, motivation, aggression) but is inferred from behaviour or performance.

Operationalisation

The process of turning a fuzzy, abstract concept (like “intelligence” or “aggression”) into something that can be measured concretely (e.g., IQ test scores, number of verbal attacks).

Construct

A theoretical idea or concept (such as intelligence, overconfidence, wisdom) that researchers define and measure using operationalisations.

Implicit theory of intelligence

A person’s everyday, informal beliefs about what intelligence is and what an intelligent person is like. These are not necessarily based on formal data and are often shaped by culture, age, and personal experience.

Explicit theory of intelligence

A formal, scientific theory of intelligence developed by researchers, based on systematic data (e.g., test performance, factor analysis).

Layperson (or lay conception)

A non-expert member of the public; in this context, someone without specialist training who still holds beliefs/theories about intelligence.

Expert (in intelligence research)

A psychologist or researcher who studies intelligence professionally and develops explicit, data-driven theories.

Practical problem-solving ability

A facet of intelligence referring to the ability to reason logically about everyday problems, especially when solutions are not obvious and situations are complex.

Verbal ability

The capacity to use language effectively – including vocabulary, verbal fluency, clear expression, and understanding spoken or written language.

Social competence

Skills that allow individuals to function effectively in social situations, including understanding others, being accepted by others, and navigating social relationships.

Academic intelligence

A form of intelligence associated with success in educational settings – often connected to book learning, exams, and formal academic tasks.

Everyday intelligence

Intelligence as reflected in daily life – managing practical problems, relationships, and real-world situations, not just academic tasks.

Unintelligence

Behaviours or characteristics people associate with a lack of intelligence (e.g., poor decision-making, not learning from mistakes).

Cultural conceptions of intelligence

The ways different cultures define and value intelligence (e.g., Western emphasis on speed and efficiency vs Eastern inclusion of social, historical, and spiritual dimensions).

Western conceptions of intelligence

Implicit theories common in Western cultures that emphasise quick mental processing, efficiency, problem-solving speed, and clear verbal articulation.

Eastern (Non-Western) conceptions of intelligence

Implicit theories that include not only cognitive skills but also social harmony, historical knowledge, and spiritual considerations when solving problems.

Everyday competence

The ability to handle daily tasks and challenges effectively in real-life contexts (e.g., managing finances, dealing with practical problems).

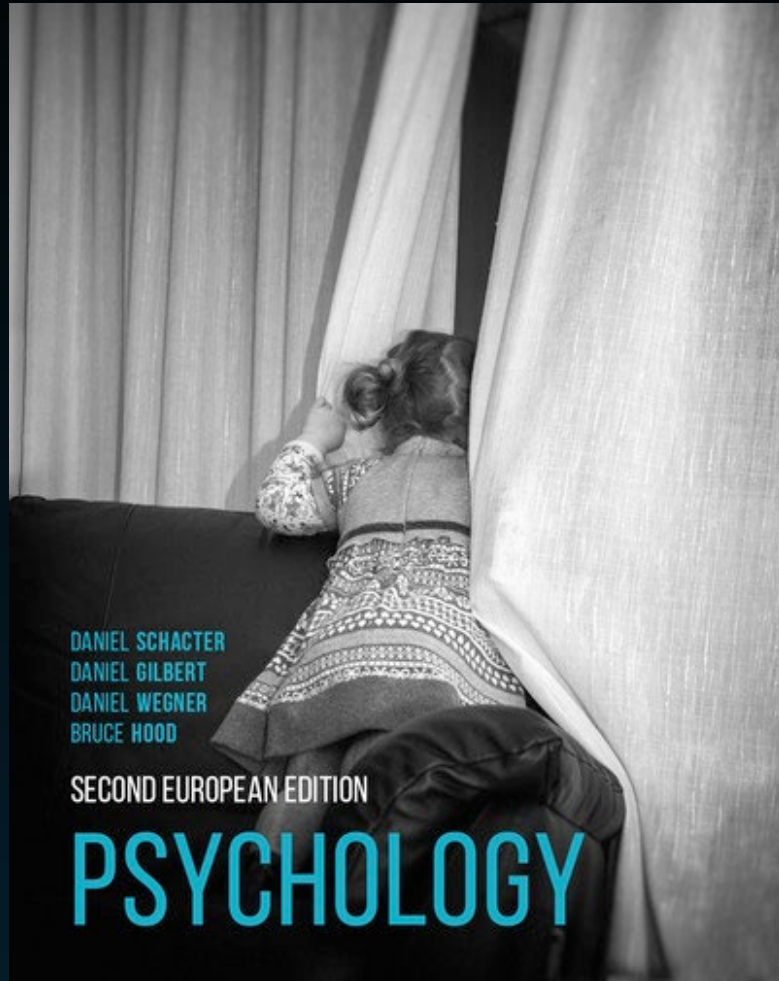
Ability to deal with novelty

How well someone can handle new, unfamiliar situations – a component often associated with intelligence, especially in younger adults.

Life-span perspective on intelligence

The idea that conceptions of what “intelligent behaviour” looks like differ depending on age (e.g., babies vs children vs adults vs older adults).

Essential reading for *Intelligence* section of this module



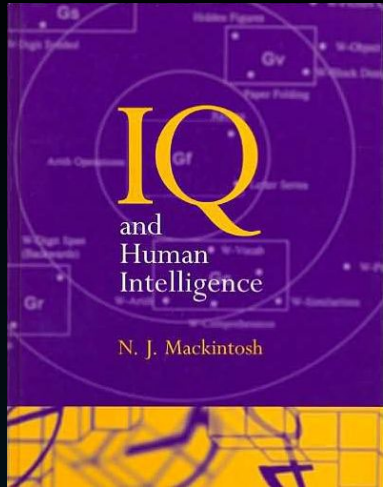
Schacter, D., Gilbert, D., Wegner, D., Hood, B. (2016)

Psychology. Second European Edition.

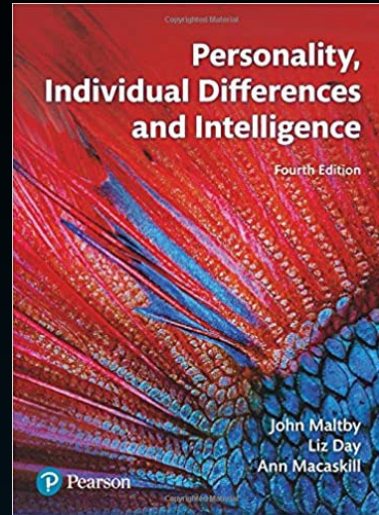
Palgrave Macmillan.

Chapter 9: Intelligence. Pgs. 356-389.

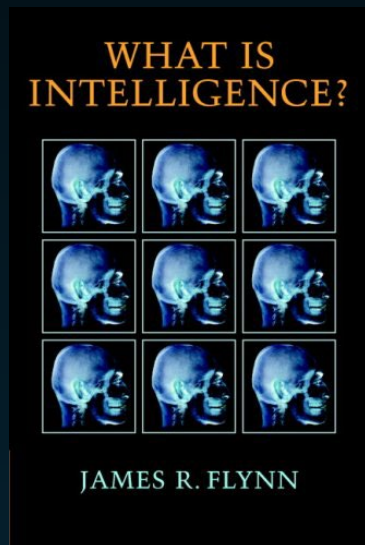
Additional reading



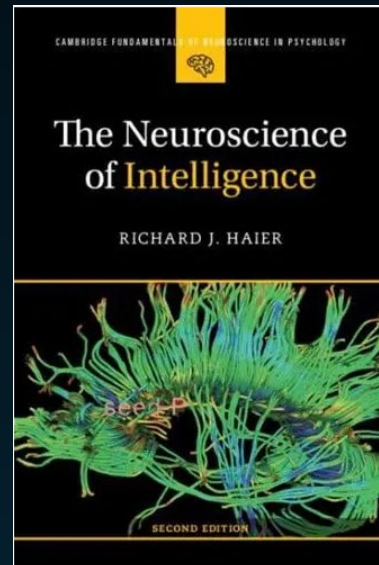
Mackintosh, N. J. (1998). *IQ and Human Intelligence*. Oxford University
£33



Maltby, J., Day, L., Macaskill, A. *Personality, Individual Differences and Intelligence*. Pearson Education Ltd.
£ 38



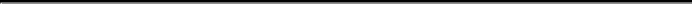
Flynn, J. R. (2007). *What is intelligence? Beyond the Flynn effect*. Cambridge University
£20



Haier, R.J. (2023) *The Neuroscience of Intelligence* Cambridge University
£28

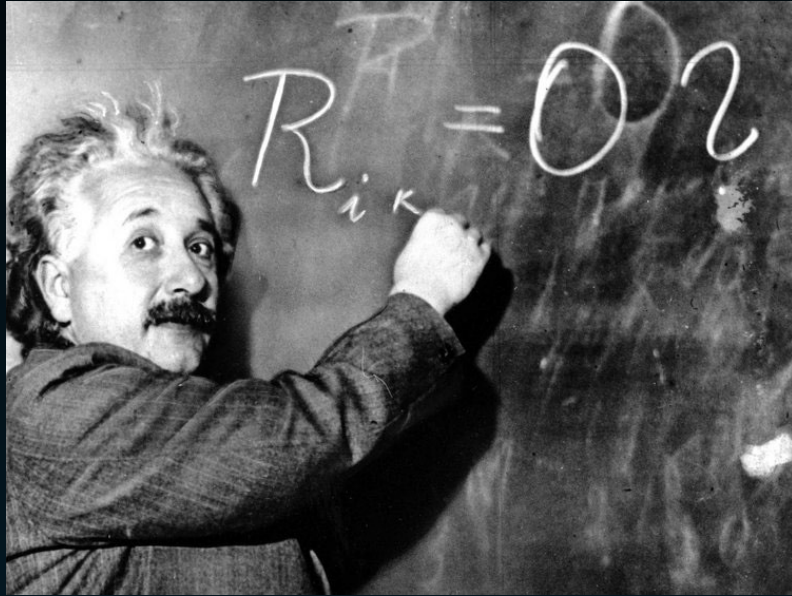


Haier, R. J., Colom, R., & Hunt, E. (2023). *The Science of Human Intelligence* Cambridge University Press.
£50


You are a ghost hunter!


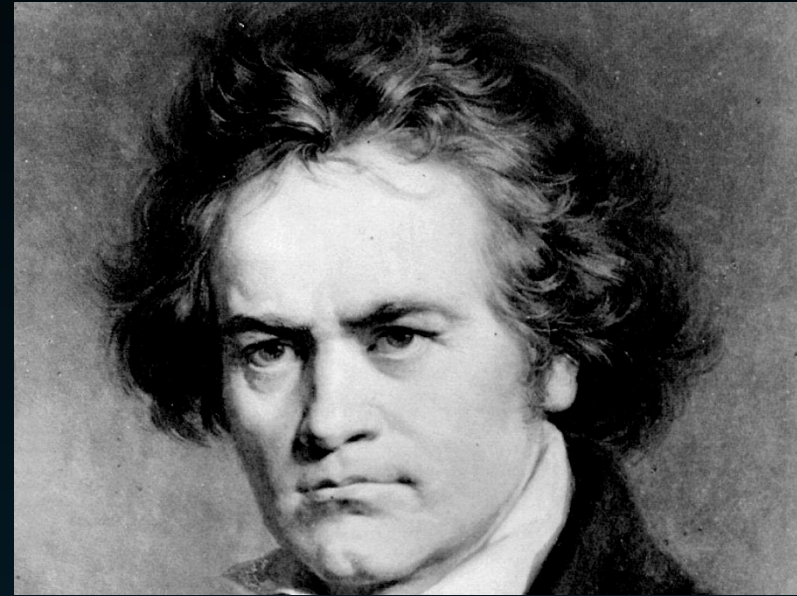


Who was more intelligent?



Albert Einstein

OR



Ludwig van Beethoven

Why does intelligence matter?

Intelligence is important to everyone in everyday life
(Sternberg, 1985)

For example:

- Parents are concerned with their children's intelligence.
 - Perception and evaluation of intelligence is crucial in (long-term) relationships.
 - Perception and evaluation of intelligence is crucial for getting a job.
- **People have an idea about the intelligence of their own and others.**



What is intelligence?

“The pianist played that piece with great insight and intelligence”

“His theory of relativity was genius”

“The footballer committed a really stupid foul”

“It was stupid of me to say that to John in front of Mary”

“Computers are not really intelligent, they are just programmed to follow instructions”

“What a clever baby she was to find the hidden toy”

“Chimpanzees are more intelligent than monkeys, because they can use tactical deception to manipulate other members of their group”

What is intelligence?

General mental efficiency; innate general cognitive ability

Burt (1949,1955)

The aggregate or global capacity of the individual to act purposefully, to think rationally, and to deal effectively with his environment

Wechsler (1944)

A quintessentially high-level skill at the summit of a hierarchy of intellectual skills

Butcher (1968)

A general reasoning capacity useful in problem-solving tasks of all kinds

Kline (1991)

Intelligence is what intelligence tests measure

Boring (1923)

What is intelligence?

Intelligence is a very general mental capability that, among other things, involves the ability to reason, plan, solve problems, think abstractly, comprehend complex ideas, learn quickly, and learn from experience. It is not merely book learning, a narrow academic skill, or test-taking smarts. Rather, it reflects a broader and deeper capability for comprehending our surroundings - 'catching on', 'making sense' of things, or 'figuring out' what to do.

Gottfredson (1997)

Individuals differ from one another in their ability to understand complex ideas, to adapt effectively to the environment, to learn from experience, to engage in various forms of reasoning, to overcome obstacles by taking thought.

American Psychological Association (APA) Task Force on Intelligence (1995)

Intelligence is... “rapid and accurate problem solving”.

Jung & Chohan (2019)

What is intelligence?

Many definitions of intelligence share a single attribute:

Intelligence is a **general** mental ability

Intelligence is a very general mental capability that, among other things, involves the ability to reason, plan, solve problems, think abstractly, comprehend complex ideas, learn quickly, and use knowledge to adapt to new situations. It is a narrow academic capability for complex tasks, or 'figuring out'.

Gottfredson

Individuals use intelligence to adapt effectively to their environment. Intelligence involves the use of various forms of reasoning, to overcome obstacles by taking thought.

American Psychological Association (APA) Task Force on Intelligence (1995)

Intelligence is... "rapid and accurate problem solving".

Jung & Chohan (2019)

What is intelligence?

Two other themes common in definitions of intelligence:

Capacity to *learn* from *experience*

Capacity to *adapt* to *environment*

Intelligence is a very general mental capability that, among other things, involves the ability to reason, plan, solve problems, think abstractly, comprehend complex ideas, learn quickly, and use knowledge to adapt to new situations. It is a narrow academic capability for complex 'figuring out' things, or

Gottfredson

Individuals use intelligence to adapt effectively to their environment. Intelligence involves the use of various forms of reasoning, to overcome obstacles by taking thought.

American Psychological Association (APA) Task Force on Intelligence (1995)

Intelligence is... "rapid and accurate problem solving".

Jung & Chohan (2019)

Using language as a scientific device to simplify complexity

The Principles of Psychology (1890)

Volume 1

Chapter IV -	Habit
Chapter VI -	The mind-stuff theory
Chapter IX -	The stream of thought
Chapter X -	The consciousness of self
Chapter XI -	Attention
Chapter XIII -	Discrimination and comparison
Chapter XIV -	Association
Chapter XIX -	The perception of 'things'
Chapter XV-	Perception of time
Chapter XX -	The perception of space
Chapter XVI-	Memory

Volume 2

Chapter XVII -	Sensation
Chapter XVIII -	Imagination
Chapter XXI -	The perception of reality
Chapter XXII -	Reasoning
Chapter XXIII -	Production of movement
Chapter XXIV -	Instinct
Chapter XXV -	The emotions
Chapter XXVI -	Will



William James
(1842-1910)

Starting from behavioural psychology

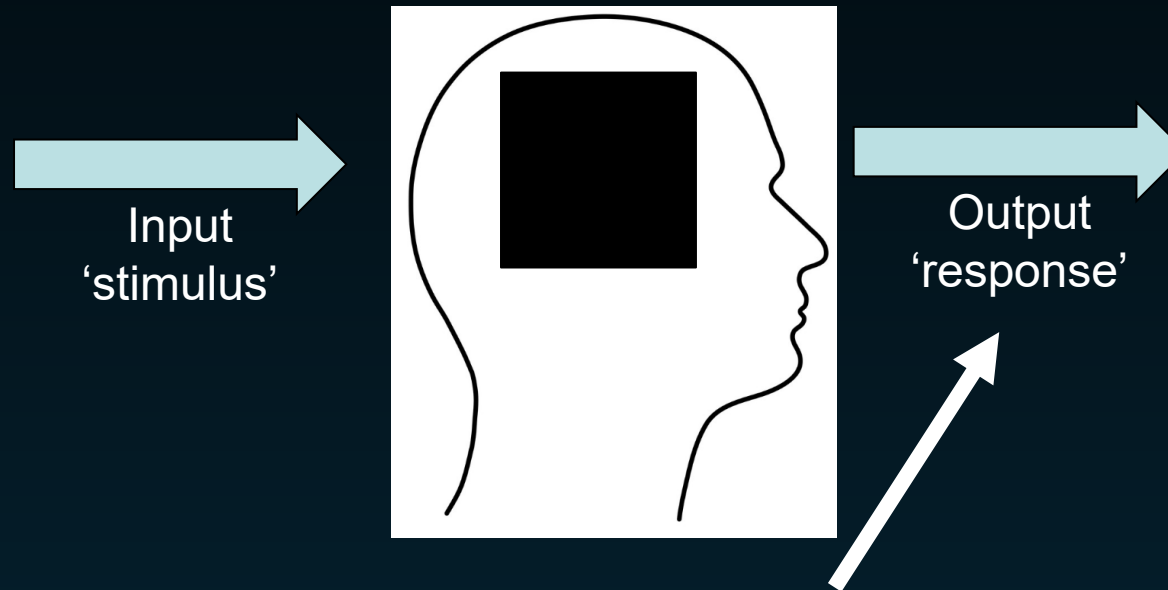
School of behaviorism – ‘laws of behaviour’



B.F. Skinner
(1904-1990)

Breaking down psychology to its simplest elements
Stimulus-response associations

Brain is a sealed black box that you can't look inside



Some kind of observable behaviour

Understanding how the brain processes complex cognitive constructs is not easy!!

Your High-Tech Brain Follow the 8 Sensory Inputs

Red Circuits are inhibitory, all other colors are excitatory

86+ Billion Neurons

15+ Billion Neurons in the Cerebral Cortex

15+ Trillion Connections in the Cerebral Cortex

Avg of 1,000-10,000 Connections/Synapses per Neuron

(Processor equivalent of 45,000 17 Dual Core Processors since computers work like transistor switches)

The Cortex is a 6 layer folded circuit board filled with electronics

1 mm² of cortex contains 50,000+ Neurons

making over 100 Million Synapses (switches)

(Apple 4S processor (iPhone 5) has about 25 billion transistors (switches) in the little box)

The Total Surface area of the Cerebral Cortex = 2,500 cm²

"These frontal circuits have been associated with decision making. 1) the OFC 2) the DLPFC, and 3) the ACC, important in sorting among conflicting options, as well as outcome-processing." - The Functional Neuroanatomy of Decision-Making

"It can now be recognized that the region (Orbital and Medial Prefrontal Cortex) as a whole receives highly processed sensory afferents, provides for cortical influence over visceral functions, and participates in high-level cognitive and emotional processes." - The Organization of Networks within the Orbital and Medial Prefrontal Cortex of Rats, Monkeys and Humans.

"Religious conviction acts like an anxiolytic, reducing emotional reactions to errors or uncertainty, providing people with a meaningful system helping them to understand the complex and uncertain world that we live in. In physiological terms, it reduces ACC activity and consequently distress." - The Anterior Cingulate Cortex

"Visual Processing in the Retina

125 Million Rods & 6 Million Cone Photoreceptors

In 1 Millie-seconds in the Optic Nerve

compresses video, detects movement, adjusts exposure system scans for objects on a collision path and automatically sends control to fovea

estimated processing power of over four Apple 4S processors per eye

Motion Detection Foveal Reflex

Smooth Pursuit Foveal Reflex

1. Sight

125 Million Rods

Peripheral Low Resolution View

Peripheral Motion Sensing Circuitry provides visual reflexes

Fovea High Resolution View

200,000 Cones in Fovea

Fovea Notch Diameter is 1.5 mm

Retina Thickness is .12 mm, area is 2,500 mm²

The retina does not simply send a picture to the brain. The retina spatially encodes (compresses) the image to fit the limited capacity of the optic nerve.

"It is now clear that even fairly innocuous-looking experiences can profoundly affect brain development and that the range of experiences that can alter brain development is much larger than had once been believed." Experience and the developing prefrontal cortex

2. Smell

12 Million Olfactory Receptor Cells (Human)

1 Billion Olfactory Receptor Cells (Dog)

5 Billion Olfactory Receptor Cells (Hound)

"The human face is an engineering marvel. Underneath our skin, a large number of muscles allow us to produce many configurations." - A Model of the Perception of Facial Expressions of Emotion by Humans

3. Taste

5-10 Receptors per Taste Bud

9,000 Taste Buds

Every square centimetre of your skin contains around 200 pain receptors but only 15 receptors for pressure, 5 for cold and 1 for warmth.

4. Touch

8. Facial Expressions

Automatically Produced and Read

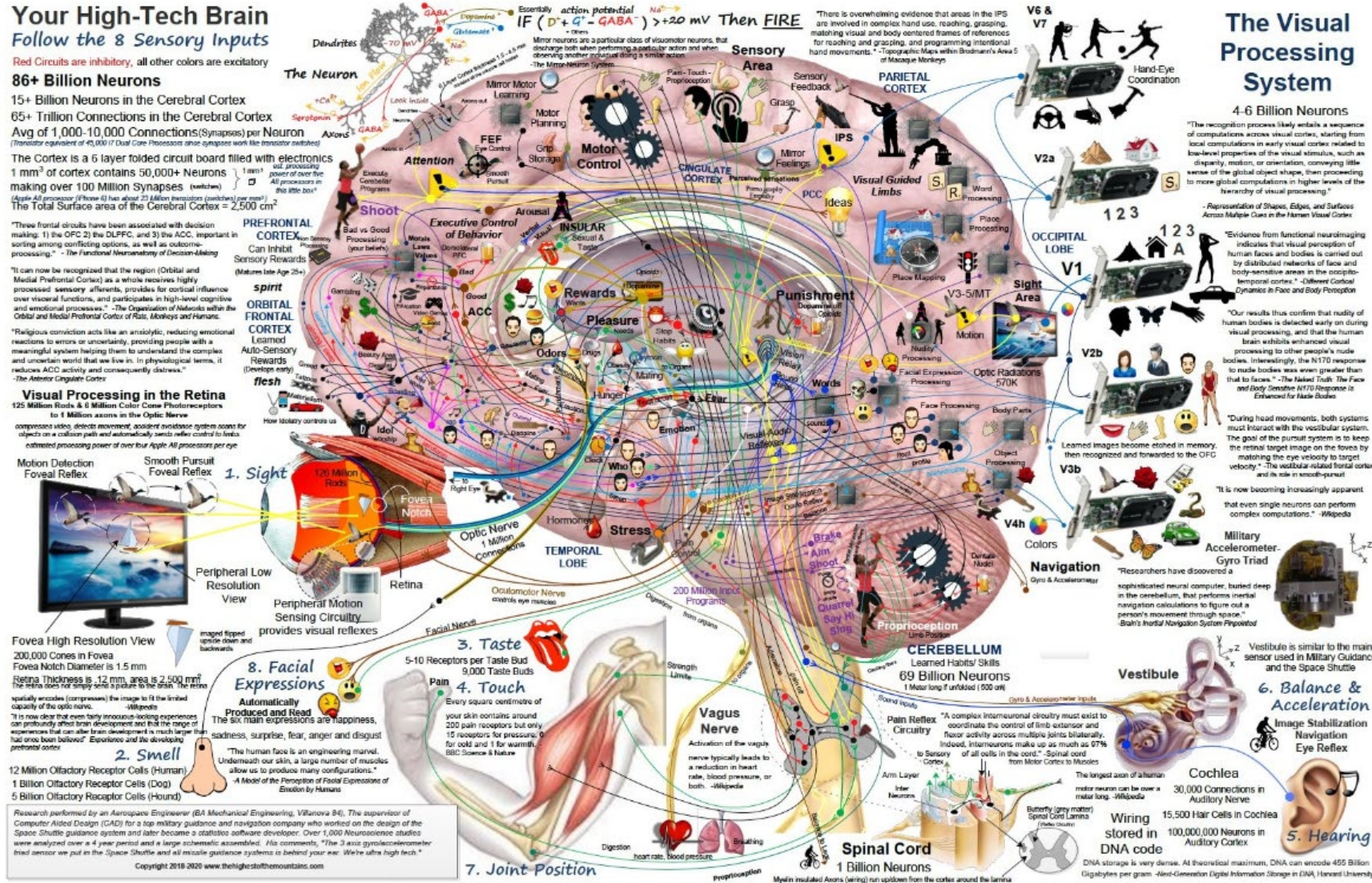
The six main expressions are happiness, sadness, surprise, fear, anger and disgust

"The human face is an engineering marvel. Underneath our skin, a large number of muscles allow us to produce many configurations." - A Model of the Perception of Facial Expressions of Emotion by Humans

5. Hearing

6. Balance & Acceleration

7. Joint Position



The Visual Processing System

4-6 Billion Neurons

"The recognition process likely entails a sequence of computations across visual cortex, starting from local computations in early visual cortex related to low-level properties of the visual stimulus, such as disparity, motion, or orientation, conveying little sense of the global object shape, then proceeding to more global computations in higher levels of the hierarchy of visual processing."

- Representation of Shapes, Edges, and Surfaces Across Multiple Cues in the Human Visual Cortex

"Evidence from functional neuroimaging indicates that visual perception of human faces and bodies is carried out by distributed networks of face and body-sensitive areas in the occipito-temporal cortex." - Different Cortical Dynamics in Face and Body Perception

"Our results thus confirm that reality of human bodies is detected early on during visual processing, and that the human brain exhibits enhanced visual processing to other people's nude bodies. Interestingly, the N170 response to nude bodies was even greater than that to faces." - The Naked Truth: The Face and Body Sensitive N170 Response is Enhanced for Nude Bodies

"During head movements, both systems must interact with the vestibular system. The goal of the pursuit system is to keep the retinal target image on the fovea by matching the eye velocity to target velocity." - The vestibular related pursuit system and its role in smooth-pursuit

"It is now becoming increasingly apparent that even single neurons can perform complex computations." - Wikipedia

Military Accelerometer: Gyro Triad

"Researchers have discovered a sophisticated neural computer, buried deep in the cerebellum, that performs mental navigation calculations to figure out a person's movement through space." - Brain's Mental Navigation System Pioneered

Vestibule

Vestibule is similar to the main sensor used in Military Guidance and the Space Shuttle

6. Balance & Acceleration

Image Stabilization

Navigation

Eye Reflex

Cochlea

30,000 Connections in Auditory Nerve

15,500 Hair Cells in Cochlea

100,000,000 Neurons in Auditory Cortex

5. Hearing

Wiring stored in DNA code

DNA storage is very dense. At theoretical maximum, DNA can encode 455 Billion Gigabytes per gram. - Next-Generation Digital Information Storage in DNA, Harvard University

Spinal Cord

1 Billion Neurons

Myelin insulated Axons (wiring) run up/down from the cortex around the lamina

Proprioception

Strength Limbs

Vagus Nerve

Activation of the vagus nerve typically leads to a reduction in heart rate, blood pressure, or both. - Wikipedia

Digestion

Heart rate, blood pressure

Breathing

Proprioception

Strength Limbs

Vagus Nerve

Activation of the vagus nerve typically leads to a reduction in heart rate, blood pressure, or both. - Wikipedia

Digestion

Heart rate, blood pressure

Breathing

Proprioception

Strength Limbs

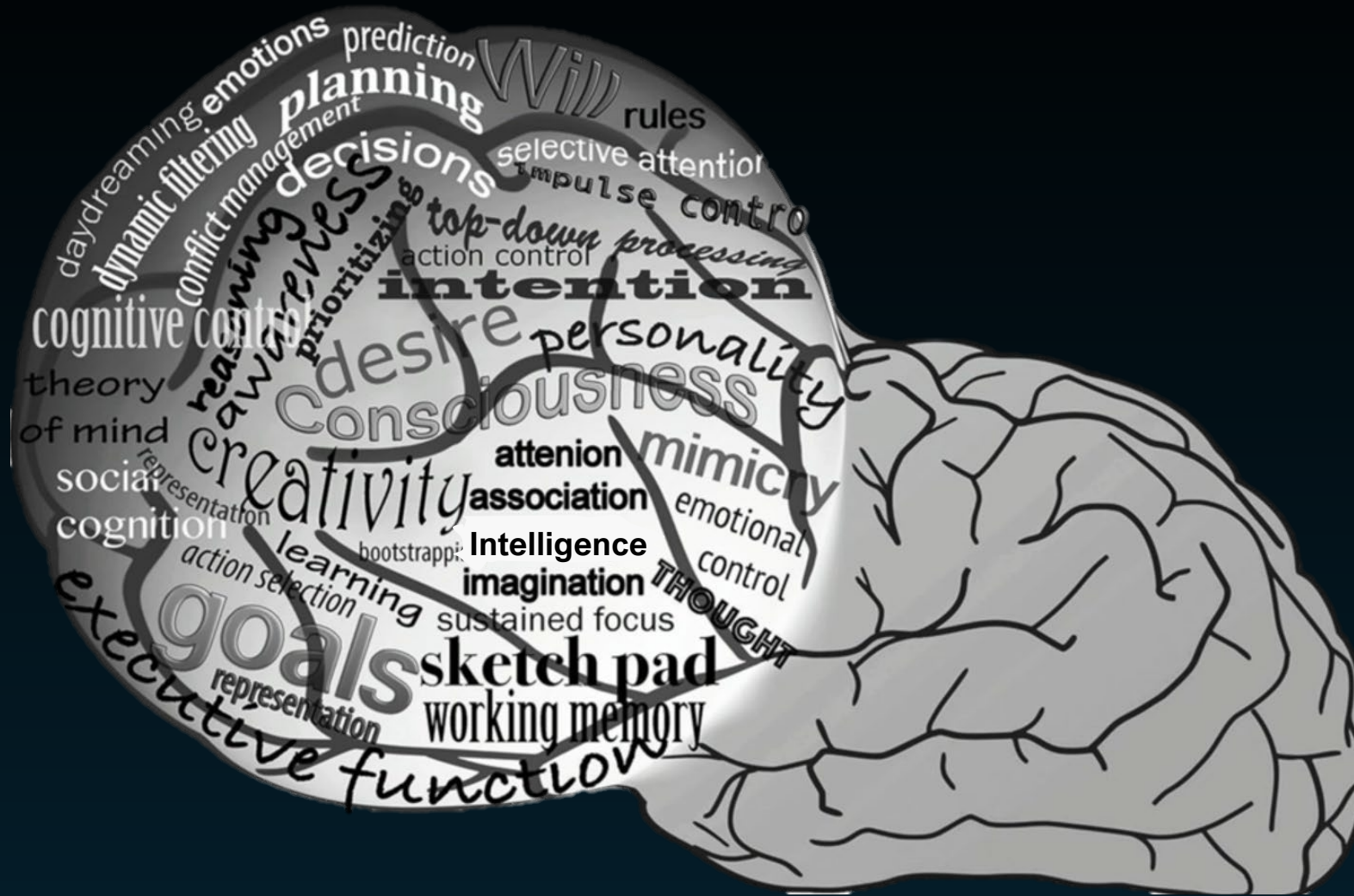
Vagus Nerve

Activation of the vagus nerve typically leads to a reduction in heart rate, blood pressure, or both. - Wikipedia

Digestion

Heart rate, blood pressure

“Boxology”: ideas -> structures



Source: Gyorgy Buzsaki talk: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bll2kw7ufno>

Hypothetical construct

- Theoretical definition
- A hypothetical construct is an explanatory variable which is not directly observable

→ **Example:** *Intelligence, Motivation, Aggression, Wisdom, Creativity, Gender, etc.*

- Creation of construct is a part of operationalization

Operationalisation

- *Process of defining a fuzzy concept*
- *To make a concept clearly distinguishable and measureable*
- *To understand it in terms of empirical observations*

Construct

Intelligence

Aggression

Overconfidence

Operationalisation

e.g. Number of questions on IQ test

e.g. Number of verbal attacks in a conversation

e.g. Perceived vs ACTUAL performance

Partitioning between 'Implicit' and 'Explicit' theories of intelligence

Implicit



- Constructs in a person's mind
- Used for formulating cross-cultural views about intelligence
- Can help understand or provide basis for explicit theories
- Data comes from asking people their notion of intelligence
- Drive the way ppl. evaluate their own & other ppl.'s intelligence

Explicit



- Conducted by scientists
- Based on data collected
- Performance on tasks presumed to measure intelligence
- Constructs – could be factors, components, schemata
- Been tricky to agree on operational definition of intelligence

Research into implicit theories of intelligence

... has shown that implicit theories of intelligence depend on the sample or population examined.



Sternberg et al. (1981) investigated individual conceptions of intelligence in:

- People studying in a college library (n=61)
 - People entering a supermarket (n=62)
 - People waiting for a train in a railway station (n=63)
- } groups of laypersons

Phase 1: People were asked to list behaviour that were characteristic of

- Intelligence
- Academic intelligence
- Everyday intelligence
- Unintelligence

Phase 2: Other people were asked to rate how well each of behaviours listed reflected aspects of intelligence.

How do lay-people describe an intelligent person ?

Gets to the heart of problems

Accepts others for what they are

Is verbally fluent

Reasons logically and well

Identifies connections among ideas

Admits mistakes

Makes good decision

Displays interest in the world at large

Has social conscience

Writes without difficulty

Converses well

Displays a good vocabulary

Sees all aspects of a problem

Speaks clearly and articulately

Displays curiosity

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Results: Sternberg found three dimensions of intelligence in laypersons

I. Practical problem solving ability

Ability to be practical and logical with regard to daily problems in various situations and relationships, especially when one cannot see a way out.

Reasons logically and well.	.77
Identifies connections among ideas.	.77
Sees all aspects of a problem.	.76
Keeps an open mind.	.73
Responds thoughtfully to others' ideas.	.70
Sizes up situations well.	.69
Gets to the heart of problems.	.69
Interprets information accurately.	.66
Makes good decisions.	.65
Goes to original sources for basic information.	.64
Poses problems in an optimal way.	.62
Is a good source of ideas.	.62
Perceives implied assumptions and conclusions.	.62
Listens to all sides of an argument.	.61
Deals with problems resourcefully.	.61

II. Verbal ability

Ability to express yourself and converse with others confidently and with some eloquence.

Speaks clearly and articulately.	.83
Is verbally fluent.	.82
Converses well.	.76
Is knowledgeable about a particular field of knowledge.	.74
Studies hard.	.70
Reads with high comprehension.	.70
Reads widely.	.69
Deals effectively with people.	.68
Writes without difficulty.	.65
Sets aside time for reading.	.64
Displays a good vocabulary.	.61
Accepts social norms.	.61
Tries new things.	.60

III. Social competence

Skills necessary to be accepted and fulfilled socially. High levels of knowledge, understanding, competency, motivation and confidence in terms of themselves and others.

Accepts others for what they are.	.88
Admits mistakes.	.74
Displays interest in the world at large.	.72
Is on time for appointments.	.71
Has social conscience.	.70
Thinks before speaking and doing.	.70
Displays curiosity.	.68
Does not make snap judgments.	.68
Makes fair judgments.	.66
Assesses well the relevance of information to a problem at hand.	.66
Is sensitive to other people's needs and desires.	.65
Is frank and honest with self and others.	.64
Displays interest in the immediate environment.	.64

(adopted from Sternberg et al., 1981)

Experts' ratings of the behaviours in an ideally intelligent person.

140 experts in the field of intelligence (psychologists with doctoral degrees doing research on intelligence in major university and research centres around the country).

I. Verbal intelligence

Displays a good vocabulary.	.74
Reads with high comprehension.	.74
Displays curiosity.	.68
Is intellectually curious.	.66
Sees all aspects of a problem.	.66
Learns rapidly.	.65
Appreciates knowledge for its own sake.	.65
Is verbally fluent.	.65
Listens to all sides of an argument before deciding.	.64
Displays alertness.	.64
Thinks deeply.	.64
Shows creativity.	.64
Converses easily on a variety of subjects.	.64
Reads widely.	.63
Likes to read.	.62
Identifies connections among ideas.	.60

II. Problem solving ability

Able to apply knowledge to problems at hand.	.74
Makes good decisions.	.73
Poses problems in an optimal way.	.73
Displays common sense.	.66
Displays objectivity.	.66
Solves problems well.	.66
Plans ahead.	.64
Has good intuitions.	.62
Gets to the heart of problems.	.62
Appreciates truth.	.61
Considers the end result of actions.	.61
Approaches problems thoughtfully.	.60

III. Practical intelligence

Sizes up situations well.	.84
Determines how to achieve goals.	.83
Displays awareness to world around him or her.	.69
Displays interest in the world at large.	.63

(adopted from Sternberg et al., 1981)

Replies of 2 groups (laypersons vs experts) not identical but converged on 3 important aspects of intelligence: **problem-solving**, **verbal ability** and **social competence**

Laypersons' Implicit theories across cultures

“... conceptions of intelligence change depending on what area of the world you live in”
(Maltby et al., 2007)

Western culture: emphasis on the speed of mental processing and the ability to gather, assimilate and sort quickly and efficiently.

Intelligent person:

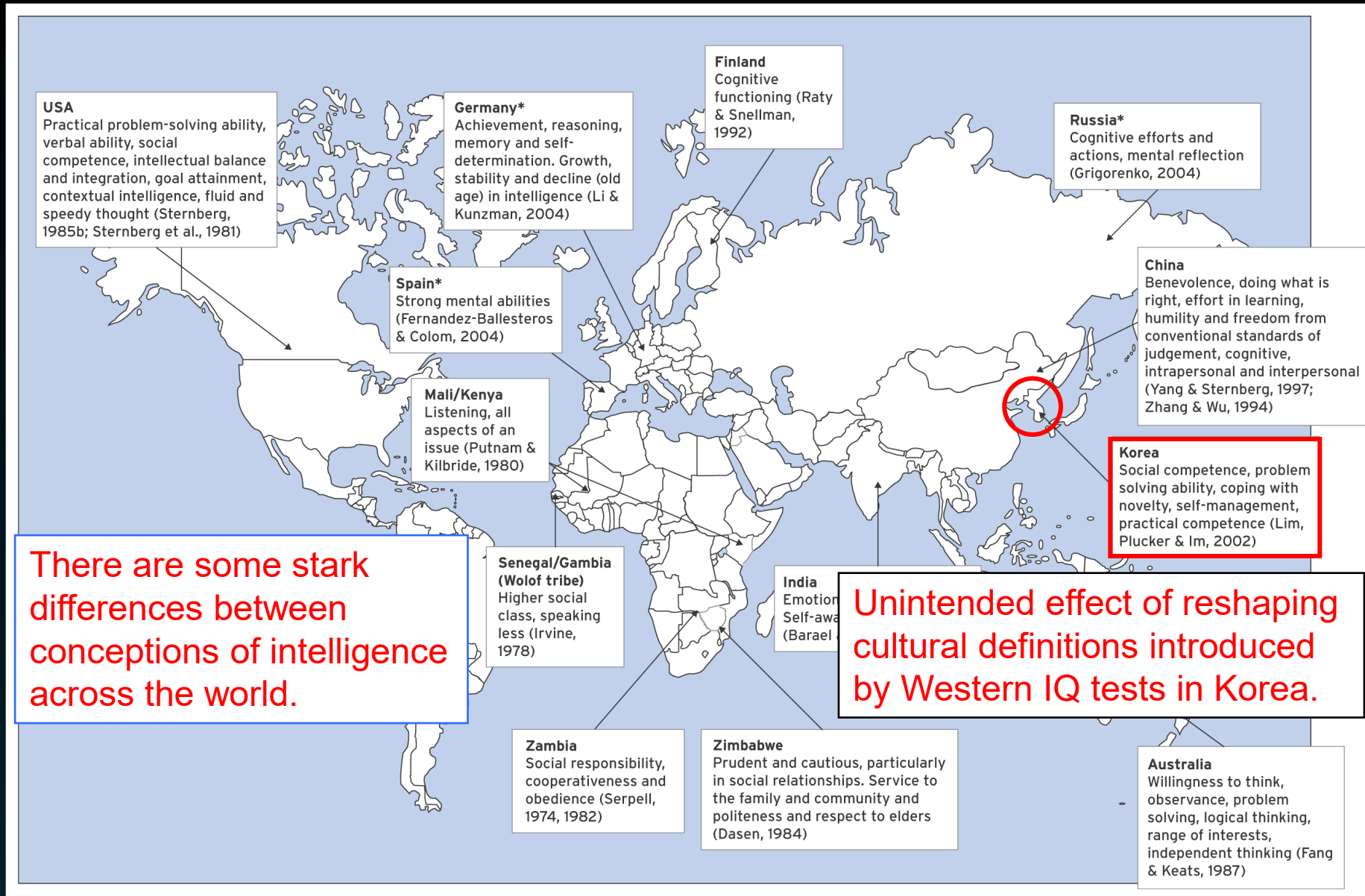
- can see answers to problems quickly and then act on them
- comes up with the solution first
- articulates these ideas verbally, clearly, fluently and in a precise manner

Non-Western (Eastern) culture: good cognitive skills, good memory but also social, historical and spiritual aspects of everyday interaction.

Problem solving skills include not only the individual but also considers

- (a) family and friends (seeking advice)
- (b) knowledge of history (knowing how people have approached this problem in the past)
- (c) own spiritual needs (consequences for the human soul)

Implicit Theories of Intelligence by Countries Around the World



Implicit theories of intelligence across the life span

How do people perceive intelligence at different stages of life span?
(Do people expect intelligent behaviour in children to be the same as in adults?)



There is clear evidence that conceptions of intelligence differ for different ages.

Siegler & Richards (1982) asked US adults to describe ideal intelligent persons at the age of 6 months, 2 years, 10 years, and as adults.

- **6 months** (ideal intelligent baby): able to recognize people and objects, shows signs of motor coordination, shows levels of awareness, makes some verbalisations
- **2 years of age**: verbal abilities, evidence of an ability to learn, awareness of people and environment, motor coordination, curiosity
- **10 years of age**: verbal ability, learning, problem solving, reasoning, creativity
- **Adults**: problem solving, verbal ability, reasoning, creativity

Concepts of intelligence in young, middle-aged and older adults

- Average intelligence was defined in all age groups as (a) ability to deal with novelty, (b) everyday competence and (c) verbal competence

Ability to deal with novelty

Is able to analyze topics in new and original ways
Is interested in gaining knowledge and learning new things
Is open-minded to new ideas and trends
Is able to learn and reason with new kinds of concepts
Displays curiosity
Discovers new ideas
Is interested in his or her career
Is able to perceive and store new information
Is inquisitive
Thinks quickly
Is able to comprehend new tasks
Thinks about future and sets goals
Is always trying to better himself or herself
Has an active mind

Everyday competence

Displays good common sense
Acts in a mature manner
Acts responsibly
Is interested in family and home life
Adjusts to life situations
Deals effectively with problems and stress
Has high moral values
Appreciates young and old individuals
Displays wisdom in actions and thoughts
Makes rational decisions

Berg & Sternberg (1992)

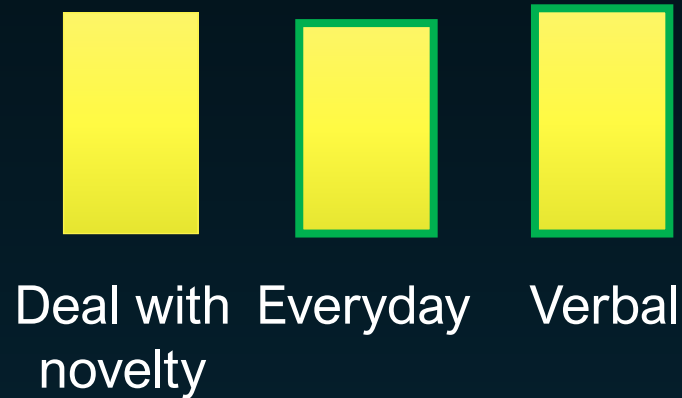
Concepts of intelligence in young, middle-aged and older adults

- For exceptional intelligence...
- Ability to deal with novelty perceived most likely for hypothetical 30-year-old than a 50 or 70-year-old
- Everyday & verbal competence perceived most likely for hypothetical 50 & 70-year-old than 30-year-old

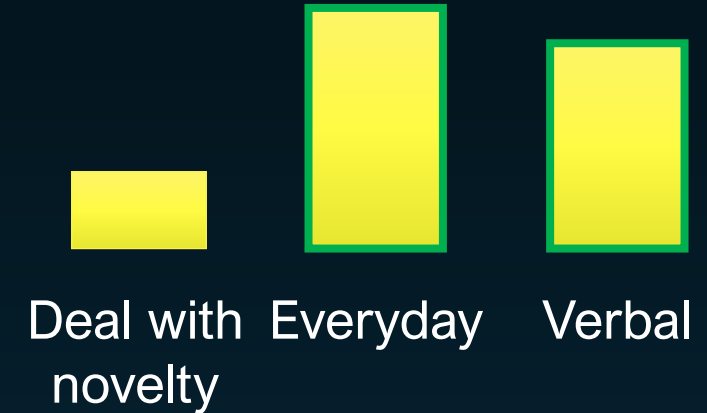
30-year-old



50-year-old



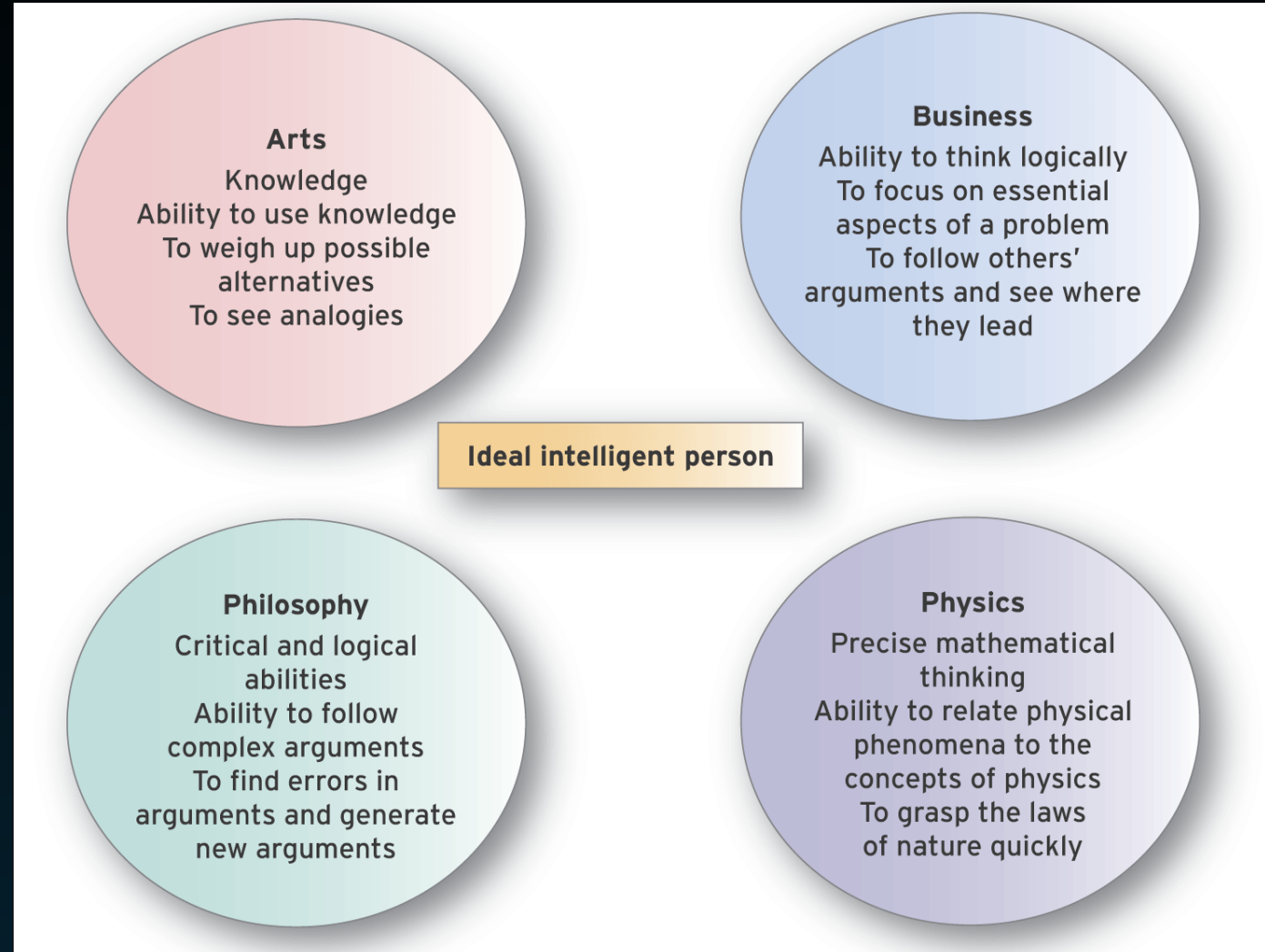
70-year-old



Similarities and differences between expert implicit theories of intelligence across academic disciplines

Sample: 200 professors in the academic areas of arts, business, philosophy and physics.

Task: Describe an ideal intelligent person in your area of study.



Summary

- Intelligence is seen as central to human life.
- Implicit theories of intelligence drive the way in which people perceive and evaluate their own intelligence and that of others.
- Implicit theories of intelligence can lead to more formal theories of intelligence that researchers can investigate.
- Sternberg's three dimensions of intelligence: practical problem solving, verbal ability and social competence.
- Western cultures emphasis on the speed of mental processing and the ability to gather, assimilate and sort information quickly and efficiently.
- Eastern cultures extend these ideas to social, historical and spiritual aspects of everyday interactions, knowledge, problem solving.
- People perceive intelligence at different stages of life differently.
- Individuals at different ages perceive intelligent behaviour differently.
- Intelligence experts in different academic disciplines differ in their conceptions of intelligence.